> of the best active managers struggle to keep up with the market over extended periods cemented it for me.
>
> Look at the trajectory of the market over any ten-, twenty-, or thirty-year period. The key is to participate and ignore the noise. I haven't looked back. When the market does well, I'm excited. When the market goes down, I view it like it's going on sale. Fear is no longer part of this equation.

According to Collins, his writings gained popularity when he curated them as "The Stock Series" on his blog and then published them in *The Simple Path to Wealth*. He began to get more feedback from sophisticated investors. They thought his advice was great for others who, like his daughter, had little to no interest in investing and didn't want to put in the work. However, he points out, while this is typically meant as a compliment, it exposes a weakness many of us have. Collins practices what he preaches. He said, "If I thought you could put in a little bit of work, or even a lot of work, and get better results than index investing . . . I would certainly be doing it."

A benefit of following a simple index investing philosophy is that it allows you to achieve outcomes greater than the vast majority of investors. The real power in following this philosophy is that you can obtain good results without taking away time or mental energy from